

Forged Fuel:

The Forged Nutrition Blueprint

The Diet for Fat Loss Without Losing Muscle

Introduction

Many people want to lose fat, but they make one critical mistake: they lose muscle at the same time.

A lean, athletic physique is not built by simply weighing less. It is built by reducing body fat while preserving the muscle you worked hard to earn.

The goal is simple:

Lose fat. Keep muscle.

Why Most Diets Fail

Most crash diets create three problems:

- Not enough protein
- Too few nutrients
- Too large of a calorie deficit

As a result, people often feel tired, lose strength, and sacrifice muscle along with body fat.

The best diet is not the fastest. It is the one you can sustain while continuing to perform, recover, and build healthy habits.

Rule #1: Prioritize Protein

Protein is the most important nutrient when trying to lose fat without losing muscle.

Protein helps:

- Support muscle recovery
- Maintain strength

- Increase fullness after meals
- Reduce muscle loss during fat loss

Build every meal around a quality protein source.

Examples include:

- Chicken
- Turkey
- Fish
- Eggs
- Greek yogurt
- Lean beef
- Cottage cheese
- Beans and legumes

Rule #2: Eat Mostly Whole Foods

Whole foods help control hunger and provide important nutrients.

Focus on:

- Fruits
- Vegetables
- Potatoes
- Rice
- Oats
- Lean meats
- Eggs
- Dairy products
- Nuts and seeds

Limit foods that are highly processed and easy to overeat.

The majority of your diet should come from foods that existed long before factories did.

Rule #3: Don't Fear Carbohydrates

Many people blame carbs for fat gain.

The truth is that carbohydrates are an important fuel source, especially for active people.

Good carbohydrate sources include:

- Fruit
- Potatoes

- Rice
- Oatmeal
- Whole grains

Carbs can help support performance, recovery, and energy levels.

Rule #4: Stay Hydrated

Water plays a major role in performance and recovery.

Benefits of proper hydration include:

- Better workouts
- Improved focus
- Better recovery
- Reduced hunger confusion

Drink water consistently throughout the day.

Rule #5: Strength Training Is Essential

The body keeps muscle when it has a reason to keep muscle.

Strength training provides that reason.

Continue challenging yourself with resistance training while focusing on good recovery and nutrition.

For a complete approach to building strength and muscle while improving body composition, follow the principles outlined in the Iron Foundation strength training program.

Remember: the goal is not simply to burn calories. The goal is to build and maintain muscle while becoming leaner.

Rule #6: Sleep Is a Secret Weapon

Poor sleep can increase hunger, reduce recovery, and make healthy choices more difficult.

Consistent sleep helps:

- Recovery
- Performance
- Energy
- Long-term body composition

Never underestimate the power of sleep.

(Forged guide to perfecting sleep is underdevelopment)

Common Mistakes

Avoid:

- Crash diets
- Skipping protein
- Eliminating entire food groups
- Chasing quick fixes
- Trying to lose fat too quickly

The goal is not temporary results.

The goal is a physique and lifestyle you can maintain.

Sample Day of Eating

The following is an example of a nutrient-dense day of eating built around protein, whole foods, healthy fats, and quality carbohydrates.

Breakfast

Protein Oatmeal Bowl

Ingredients:

- 3 whole eggs
- 1 cup egg whites
- 1 cup oats
- 1 banana
- 1 cup blueberries
- Cinnamon
- Water or milk

Why:

Provides high-quality protein, fiber, vitamins, minerals, and long-lasting energy.

Lunch

Lean Chicken Power Bowl

Ingredients:

- Grilled chicken breast
- White rice
- Broccoli
- Bell peppers
- Carrots
- Avocado
- Olive oil
- Sea salt
- Black pepper

Why:

Combines lean protein, quality carbohydrates, healthy fats, and vegetables for a balanced meal.

Snack

High-Protein Greek Yogurt Bowl

Ingredients:

- Plain Greek yogurt
- Strawberries
- Blueberries
- Honey
- Chopped almonds

Why:

Provides protein, antioxidants, calcium, and healthy fats while helping control hunger.

Dinner

Salmon Performance Plate

Ingredients:

- Wild salmon
- Roasted potatoes
- Asparagus
- Mixed greens
- Olive oil
- Lemon
- Sea salt
- Black pepper

Why:

Provides protein, omega-3 fats, fiber, vitamins, and minerals that support recovery and overall health.

Evening Snack (Optional)

Ingredients:

- Cottage cheese
- Mixed berries
- Walnuts

Why:

Provides slow-digesting protein and healthy fats that can support recovery and satiety.

The Foods Most Often Found in Lean, Healthy Diets

- Eggs
- Chicken breast
- Turkey
- Lean beef
- Salmon
- Greek yogurt
- Cottage cheese
- Oats
- Rice
- Potatoes
- Fruit
- Vegetables
- Avocados
- Nuts
- Olive oil

- Beans and legumes

No single food creates a lean physique.

The most successful diets are built around consistently eating nutrient-dense foods while maintaining healthy habits over time.

6 RULES OF FORGED NUTRITION

1. Eat protein with every meal
 2. Stay in a controlled calorie deficit
 3. Train with resistance regularly
 4. Stay active daily (steps + movement)
 5. Sleep consistently
 6. Be consistent for weeks, not days
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DAILY TARGETS BOX

Use this daily:

- Protein: 0.7–1.0g per lb of bodyweight
 - Calories: small deficit (not extreme)
 - Water: 0.5–1 oz per lb of bodyweight
 - Steps: 7,000–12,000
 - Strength training: 3–6x per week
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CALORIE FRAMEWORK (SIMPLE)

Fat loss happens when you eat slightly fewer calories than you burn.

- Maintenance = weight stays the same
- Deficit = fat loss
- Surplus = weight gain

Simple rule:

Start with a small deficit, then adjust based on weekly progress.

FLEXIBILITY RULES

Eating out:

- Prioritize protein first
- Choose grilled or simple meals
- Don't stress small extras

Weekends:

- 80/20 rule (mostly consistent, some flexibility)
- One meal won't ruin progress

If you slip:

- Return to normal next meal
 - No restriction cycles or punishment dieting
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FOOD SUBSTITUTION LIST

Protein:

Chicken → turkey, tuna, lean beef, eggs, Greek yogurt

Carbs:

Rice → potatoes, oats, pasta, bread, fruit

Fats:

Olive oil → avocado, nuts, salmon, eggs

Snacks:

Greek yogurt → cottage cheese, protein shakes

COMMON MISTAKE FIXES

If fat loss stops:

→ Slightly reduce calories or increase steps

If strength drops:

→ Increase protein and recovery

If hunger is high:

→ Add more volume foods (vegetables, potatoes)

If you feel tired:

→ Improve sleep and reduce deficit size

FLEXIBLE MEAL TEMPLATES

Breakfast template:

Protein + carbs + fruit

Lunch template:

Lean protein + carb + vegetables + fat

Dinner template:

Protein + vegetables + carb or fat

Snack template:

High-protein + fruit or nuts

3-DAY START PROTOCOL

Day 1:

- Track everything you eat

- No changes yet

Day 2:

- Hit protein goal
- Add steps target

Day 3:

- Adjust portions slightly based on intake
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PROGRESS TRACKING

Track weekly:

- Bodyweight (average)
 - Waist measurement
 - Strength performance
 - Energy levels
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RESULT TIMELINE

Week 1:

- Water weight drop
- Adjustment phase

Week 2:

- Hunger stabilizes
- Energy improves

Week 3:

- Visible fat loss begins

Week 4:

- Clear physique changes
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FORGED SYSTEM EXPLANATION

Forged is made of four parts:

- **Forged Diet** → nutrition system (this guide)
- **Iron Foundation** → strength training system
- **Warrior Conditioning** → cardio + fat loss conditioning
- **Forged Sleep** → maximize sleep quality and restoration

Together they create a complete physique system:

build muscle + lose fat + improve conditioning

STUDIES (FORGED DIET SUPPORT)

Evidence Base & Further Reading

Forged Diet is built on widely accepted principles from exercise science, nutrition research, and sports [physiology](#).

Protein + Muscle Retention

- Phillips & Van Loon (2011) — *Dietary protein for athletes*
 - Morton et al. (2018) — *Protein supplementation and resistance training gains*
 - Mettler et al. (2010) — *Higher protein intake preserves lean mass during calorie deficit*
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Calorie Deficit / Fat Loss

- Hall et al. (2011) — *Energy balance and body weight regulation*
 - Thomas, B. et al. (2016, Academy of Nutrition & Dietetics) — *Position on weight management*
 - Bray et al. (2012) — *Diet composition vs calorie balance in weight loss*
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Whole Foods / Diet Quality

- Mozaffarian et al. (2011) — *Changes in diet quality and long-term weight gain*
 - Hall et al. (2019) — *Ultra-processed foods and calorie intake*
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Carbohydrates + Performance

- Burke et al. (2011) — *Carbohydrate availability and endurance performance*
 - Jeukendrup (2017) — *Carbohydrate intake for athletic performance*
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Hydration

- Armstrong et al. (2012) — *Hydration status and physical performance*

- Popkin et al. (2010) — *Water, hydration, and health*
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Sleep + Body Composition

- Van Cauter et al. (2007) — *Sleep loss and metabolic dysfunction*
 - Taheri et al. (2004) — *Short sleep and obesity risk factors*
 - Spiegel et al. (1999) — *Sleep restriction and hormonal changes*
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BOOKS (FORGED DIET SUPPORT)

Fat Loss / Body Composition

- *Burn the Fat, Feed the Muscle* — Tom Venuto
 - *The Hungry Brain* — Stephan Guyenet
 - *Why We Get Fat* — Gary Taubes
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Nutrition + Training Science

- *Essentials of Strength Training and Conditioning* — NSCA
 - *The Renaissance Diet 2.0* — Mike Israetel
 - *Flexible Dieting* — Alan Aragon (research articles + principles)
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Recovery / Behavior

- *Why We Sleep* — Matthew Walker
- *Atomic Habits* — James Clear

